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Question:

The X coordinate of the incentre of the triangle that has the coordinates of mid points of its sides as $(0, 1)$, $(1, 1)$ and $(1, 0)$ is (2013)

Solution:

Let the position vectors of the midpoints of sides BC , AC , and AB be $\mathbf{D}$, $\mathbf{E}$, and $\mathbf{F}$ respectively.

$$\mathbf{D} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{E} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{F} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (1)$$

The position vectors of the vertices of the triangle, $\mathbf{A}$, $\mathbf{B}$, and $\mathbf{C}$, can be found from the midpoint vectors.

$$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{E} + \mathbf{F} - \mathbf{D} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (2)$$

$$\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{D} + \mathbf{F} - \mathbf{E} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (3)$$

$$\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{D} + \mathbf{E} - \mathbf{F} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} - \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (4)$$

Next, we find the lengths of the sides of $\triangle ABC$. Let a , b , and c be the lengths of the sides opposite to vertices A , B , and C .

$$a = \|\mathbf{C} - \mathbf{B}\| = \left\| \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \right\| = \sqrt{0^2 + 2^2} = 2 \quad (5)$$

$$b = \|\mathbf{A} - \mathbf{C}\| = \left\| \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix} \right\| = \sqrt{2^2 + (-2)^2} = \sqrt{8} = 2\sqrt{2} \quad (6)$$

$$c = \|\mathbf{B} - \mathbf{A}\| = \left\| \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\| = \sqrt{(-2)^2 + 0^2} = 2 \quad (7)$$

The position vector of the incentre, $\mathbf{I}$, is given by the formula:

$$\mathbf{I} = \frac{a\mathbf{A} + b\mathbf{B} + c\mathbf{C}}{a + b + c} \quad (8)$$

Substituting the vectors and side lengths:

$$\mathbf{I} = \frac{2 \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + 2\sqrt{2} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + 2 \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}}{2 + 2\sqrt{2} + 2} \quad (9)$$

$$= \frac{1}{4 + 2\sqrt{2}} \left(\begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} \right) \quad (10)$$

$$= \frac{1}{4 + 2\sqrt{2}} \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{4}{4+2\sqrt{2}} \\ \frac{4}{4+2\sqrt{2}} \end{pmatrix} \quad (11)$$

The x-coordinate of the incentre, I_x , is the first component of $\mathbf{I}$.

$$I_x = \frac{4}{4 + 2\sqrt{2}} = \frac{2}{2 + \sqrt{2}} \quad (12)$$

$$= \frac{2(2 - \sqrt{2})}{(2 + \sqrt{2})(2 - \sqrt{2})} = \frac{2(2 - \sqrt{2})}{4 - 2} = 2 - \sqrt{2} \quad (13)$$

$$\Rightarrow I_x = 2 - \sqrt{2} \quad (14)$$

